D612 – Process Improvement Solution Proposal:
Udon-ya Restaurant Order Process

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Business Objective & Challenges

Business Objective

Develop a standardized order process for franchise replication.

Challenges

01.

High customer volume

Service teams struggles when customer volume is high

02

Takeout orders

No order prioritization

03

Insufficient food prep

Ingredients are not consistently available

04

Customer feedback

No customer feedback collection

Analysis Results

Process mining results:

- 9,812 cases analyzed
- 1,094 process variants
- Throughput time delays
- 35.11% conformance rate

Conclusion: Severe process inconsistencies

Root causes/bottlenecks:

1. Disconnected kitchen & service workflows
2. Communication gaps
3. No inventory management system
4. Inconsistently prepped ingredients
5. Lack of systematic data collection and monitoring
6. No physical team coordination point

Lean wastes:

- Waiting: Coordination delays across all stakeholders, customer waits
- Motion: Searching for staff/ingredients
- Inventory: Insufficient prepped ingredients
- Underutilized talent: No customer feedback

Lean Process Solutions

1. Process Integration

Connects kitchen and service workflows through kanban system.

Eliminates:
- High customer volume delays
- Disconnected workflows
- Communication gaps
- No coordination point
- Waiting & motion wastes

2. Pull System

Replaces once daily batch of ingredients and enables demand-based inventory management

Eliminates :
- Insufficient food prep
- No inventory management system
- Inconsistently prepped ingredients
- Inventory waste

3. Takeout Order Prioritization

Systematic takeout routing through POS system

Eliminates :
- Takeout order delays
- Customer waiting waste

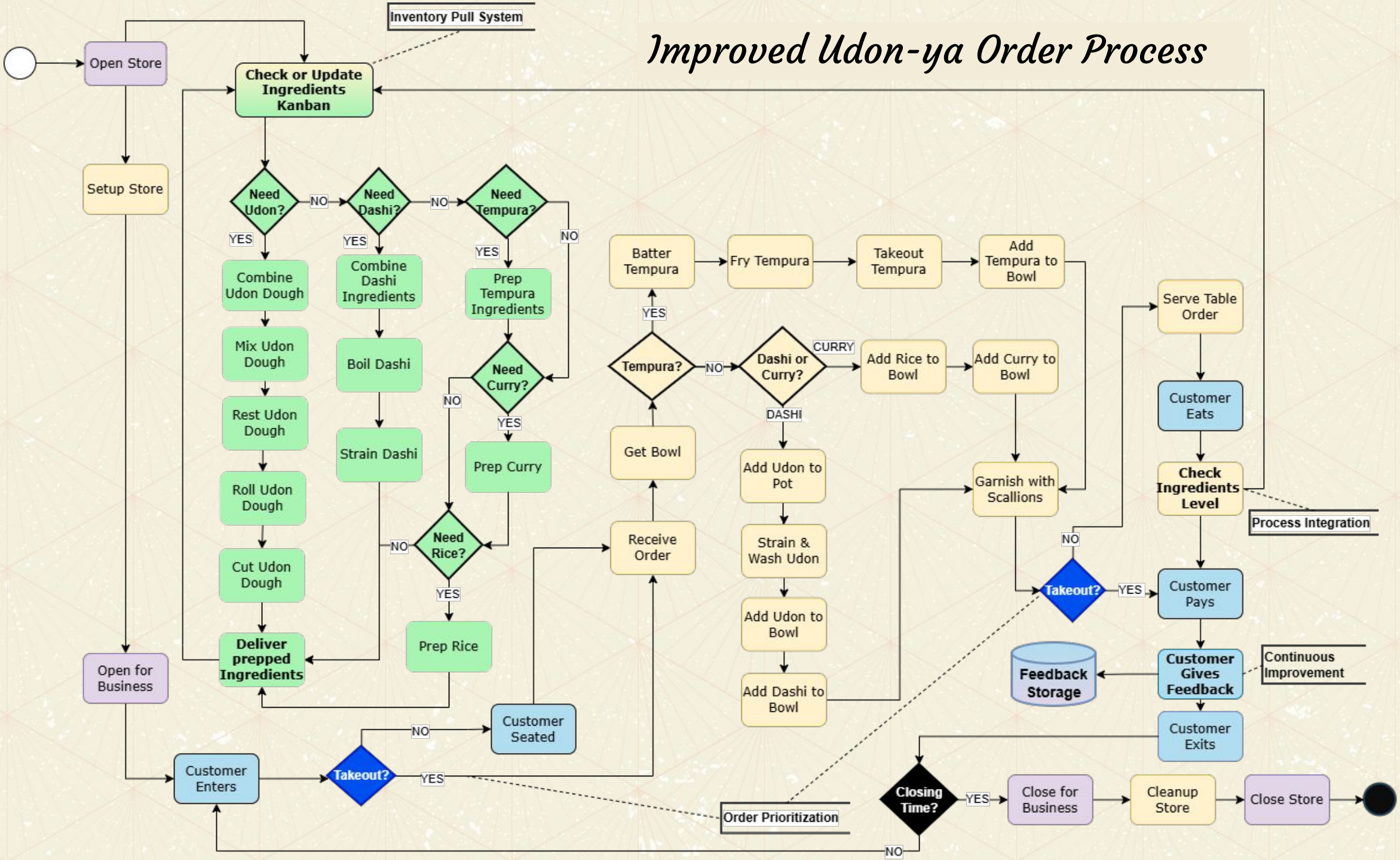
4. Continuous Improvement

Customer feedback collection enables ongoing optimization

Eliminates :
- Lack of feedback
- Lack of systematic feedback collection
- Underutilized talent waste

Four improvements working together as one integrated system

Improved Udon-ya Order Process



Measuring Success – Key Performance Indicators

Key Performance Indicator	Purpose	Goal
Process Conformance Rate	Measures standardization of process	> 80%
Food Preparation Time	Measures pull system effectiveness	< 5 minutes
Ingredients Replenishment Frequency*	Measures demand-based food prep cycle execution	8-12 cycles per day
Avg Order-to-Table time	Measures continuous flow effectiveness	< 7 minutes
Customer Satisfaction (CSAT)*	Measures customer experience	> 4.0 score

*New metric

Implementation Roadmap

Phase 1

Kitchen and service staff training

Go live: Phase 1

Week 1 | **Week 2** | **Week 3** | **Week 4**

Kickoff

- Install kanban board
- Define low ingredients threshold

Test process improvements

Daily huddle meetings

Weekly staff meetings

Continuous Improvement

Phase 2

Service staff training

Go live: Phase 2

Week 5 | **Week 6**

Kickoff

- Configure POS system
- Configure customer feedback collection
- Test system changes

Weekly staff meetings

Continuous Improvement

Managing Challenges & Risks

Risk	Severity	Mitigation Strategy
Kitchen staff resistance to more frequent prep cycles	**High**	Involve staff in setting kanban thresholds and designing methodology
Kanban signals missed	**High**	Place kanban board in easily visible location for monitoring by both teams
POS system vendor delays	**Medium**	Engage vendor early in Week 3

Key Insights

- Process mining revealed non-sequential, disconnected workflows invisible to observation alone
- Root cause analysis showed coordination failure, not individual performance issues
- Lean waste methodology directly addressed all identified bottlenecks
- 2-phased implementation critical for managing organizational change

Benefits for Udon-ya

Franchise-ready operations
Standardized workflows enable process replication

Improved customer experience
Consistent quality, reduced wait times

Inventory management
Reduced waste, faster service, reliable ingredients

Data-driven improvement
Feedback system enables ongoing optimization

Call to Action

Commit to the process

Celebrate success

Everyone is a change agent

Aim for perfection

Thanks !